

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Technical Support Ticket Escalation Process Improvement

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Business Area: IT Operations

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Version History

Version	Date	Author	Description
1.0	August 2026	Angelica Robinson	Initial Draft
1.1	August 2026	Angelica Robinson	Added requirements traceability matrix
1.2	August 2026	Angelica Robinson	Added acceptance criteria

1. Project Overview

1.1 Project Name

Technical Support Ticket Escalation Process Improvement

1.2 Business Owner

IT Operations

1.3 Project Lead

Angelica Robinson

1.4 Project Objective

The objective of this project is to improve the technical-support ticket escalation process by reducing manual communication, standardizing escalation procedures, increasing visibility into high-priority tickets, and supporting faster resolution of business-critical issues.

1.5 Business Problem

Technical-support analysts currently review incoming support tickets, determine priority, communicate escalations to the appropriate support teams, and manually update ticket activity. Heavy reliance on manual communication and status tracking may create inconsistent escalation practices, delayed responses, limited management visibility, and increased risk of missed service-level targets.

1.6 Business Goals

- Reduce repetitive manual communication.
- Standardize ticket-escalation procedures.
- Improve visibility into high-priority incidents.
- Support faster escalation and resolution.
- Improve the consistency of ticket-status updates.
- Strengthen reporting and SLA monitoring.

2. Scope

2.1 In Scope

- Review of the existing ticket-escalation workflow.
- Documentation of current-state and proposed future-state processes.
- Identification of manual steps and process gaps.
- Definition of business and functional requirements.
- Design of automated notifications and escalation routing.
- Development of reporting requirements for ticket visibility and SLA monitoring.

2.2 Out of Scope

- Replacement of the existing ticketing platform.
- Changes to network infrastructure.
- Development of custom application code.
- Changes to HR or employee disciplinary procedures.
- Production implementation of the proposed automation.

3. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role in Process	Primary Need
Employees	Submit support requests	Timely updates and resolution
Technical Support Analysts	Review and resolve tickets	Clear priorities and escalation rules
Network / Infrastructure Team	Resolve escalated technical issues	Complete and accurate escalation details
IT Management	Monitor service performance	Visibility into critical tickets and SLA risk
Business Operations	Monitor operational impact	Consistent service and reporting
System Administrator	Maintain workflow and permissions	Reliable, secure automation

4. Current-State Process

4.1 Process Summary

The current-state process relies on technical-support analysts to review tickets, assess priority, determine whether escalation is necessary, communicate with the appropriate team, update the ticket record, and notify the requesting employee. Several steps depend on individual judgment and manual follow-up.

4.2 Current-State Steps

1. Employee submits a support request.

- 2. A ticket is created in the ticketing system.
- 3. A Technical Support Analyst reviews the request.
- 4. The analyst assesses the issue and assigns a priority.
- 5. The analyst attempts initial troubleshooting.
- 6. The analyst determines whether escalation is required.
- 7. The analyst contacts the appropriate technical team.
- 8. The receiving team investigates the issue.
- 9. The analyst manually updates the ticket status.
- 10.The employee receives a status update.
- 11.The issue is resolved and the ticket is closed.

4.3 Current-State Process Map

Reference: Current_State_Ticket_Escalation_Process.pdf (separate process-map attachment).

Swimlanes: Employee | Technical Support | Network / Infrastructure | IT Management

Employee submits request → Ticket created → Analyst reviews request → Analyst assigns priority → Initial troubleshooting → Escalation decision → Technical team contacted → Receiving team investigates → Ticket updated manually → Employee notified → Ticket closed

This process map documents the current workflow and highlights the manual handoffs, individual judgment points, and repeated follow-up steps that create opportunities for standardization and automation.

5. Pain Points

Pain Point	Potential Business Impact
Manual escalation notifications	Delayed communication and response
Inconsistent priority assessment	Uneven handling of urgent incidents
Manual ticket-status updates	Additional administrative work
Limited centralized visibility	Difficulty monitoring high-priority tickets
Multiple communication channels	Inconsistent or duplicated updates
Dependence on individual follow-up	Risk of missed escalation steps
Manual reporting	Delayed performance and SLA insights

5.1 Root-Cause Summary

The process depends heavily on manual decisions, manual notifications, and repeated status updates. A standardized workflow with defined business rules could reduce variation, improve visibility, and support more consistent escalation management.

6. Future-State Process

6.1 Proposed Solution

Implement a standardized escalation workflow that evaluates ticket priority, routes qualifying tickets to the appropriate support team, sends stakeholder notifications, records escalation activity, and feeds reporting data into an operational dashboard. Microsoft Power Automate may be used to support workflow orchestration, notifications, approvals, and status tracking.

6.2 Future-State Steps

1. Employee submits a support request.
2. The ticketing system records the request.
3. Business rules evaluate priority and category.
4. High-priority tickets are identified automatically.
5. The appropriate technical team receives an automated notification.
6. IT management receives an alert for critical incidents.
7. Escalation details are recorded in a centralized tracking source.
8. The assigned team investigates and updates the ticket.
9. Status changes are communicated to the requesting employee.
10. Reporting data is refreshed for management visibility.
11. The ticket is resolved, validated, and closed.

6.3 Future-State Process Map

Reference: Future_State_Ticket_Escalation_Process.pdf (separate process-map attachment).

Swimlanes: *Employee | Ticketing System | Power Automate | Technical Team | IT Management*

Employee submits request → Ticket recorded → Priority and category rules evaluated → High-priority ticket identified → Automated routing and notification → Technical team investigates → Escalation details logged → Management dashboard updated → Employee receives status updates → Resolution validated → Ticket closed

The future-state map shows how automation can standardize routing, reduce manual notifications, improve visibility, and create an auditable escalation history.

7. Business Requirements

ID	Business Requirement
BR-001	The organization must use a consistent process for escalating high-priority technical-support tickets.
BR-002	Management must have timely visibility into critical tickets and SLA risks.
BR-003	The process must reduce unnecessary manual notifications and follow-up.

ID	Business Requirement
BR-004	Escalation activity must be documented and available for reporting.
BR-005	Employees must receive timely and consistent status updates.

8. Functional Requirements

ID	Functional Requirement
FR-001	The workflow shall evaluate tickets using defined priority and category rules.
FR-002	The workflow shall identify tickets requiring escalation.
FR-003	The workflow shall notify the assigned technical team.
FR-004	The workflow shall notify IT management of critical incidents.
FR-005	The workflow shall record the date, time, reason, and destination of each escalation.
FR-006	The workflow shall update the escalation status in the tracking source.
FR-007	The workflow shall send status notifications to the requesting employee.
FR-008	The workflow shall make escalation data available for reporting.
FR-009	Authorized users shall be able to review active and completed escalations.
FR-010	Failed workflow actions shall be logged for follow-up.

9. Nonfunctional Requirements

ID	Nonfunctional Requirement
NFR-001	Critical-ticket notifications should be sent within one minute of qualification.
NFR-002	Access to ticket and escalation data must follow role-based permissions.
NFR-003	The workflow must maintain an auditable history of escalation activity.
NFR-004	The solution should support normal business operations without disrupting the ticketing platform.
NFR-005	The workflow should be maintainable by authorized IT personnel.
NFR-006	Reporting data should refresh according to an agreed operational schedule.

10. Business Rules

Rule ID	Business Rule
RULE-001	Critical-priority tickets must be escalated immediately.
RULE-002	High-priority tickets must be routed according to issue category.
RULE-003	Escalated tickets must include the ticket number, description, priority, branch, requester, and troubleshooting completed.
RULE-004	Duplicate notifications must not be generated for the same escalation event.
RULE-005	Closed tickets must no longer appear as active escalations.

11. Success Measures and Acceptance Criteria

11.1 Acceptance Criteria

- A critical-priority ticket generates a management notification within one minute of qualification.
- A high-priority ticket routes to the correct technical team based on issue category.
- Each escalation records the ticket number, priority, timestamp, destination, and reason for escalation.
- Duplicate notifications are prevented for the same escalation event.
- Closed tickets no longer appear in the active-escalation report.
- Failed workflow actions create an error record and notify the workflow administrator.

11.2 Reporting and Dashboard Requirements

The reporting solution should provide management with timely visibility into ticket volume, escalation activity, SLA performance, and workflow reliability. Required KPIs:

- Total escalated tickets
- Active critical tickets
- Escalations by branch
- Escalations by category
- Average time to escalate
- Average time to resolve
- SLA compliance rate
- Tickets approaching SLA breach
- Automation success and failure rate
- Reopened tickets

11.3 Requirements Traceability Matrix

Business Requirement	Supporting Functional Requirements	Success Measure
BR-001: Standardize escalations	FR-001, FR-002, FR-003	Reduced average escalation time
BR-002: Improve visibility	FR-004, FR-008, FR-009	100% critical-ticket visibility
BR-003: Reduce manual work	FR-003, FR-006, FR-007	75% fewer manual escalation emails
BR-004: Document escalation activity	FR-005, FR-006, FR-008, FR-010	100% audit completeness
BR-005: Improve employee communication	FR-007	Status notifications sent for all defined changes

11.4 Success Measures

Measure	Proposed Target
Manual escalation emails	Reduce by 75%
Average escalation time	Reduce by 50%
SLA compliance	Maintain or exceed 95%
Critical-ticket visibility	100% of qualifying tickets visible
Escalation audit completeness	100% of escalation actions logged
Employee status notifications	Sent for all defined status changes

12. Assumptions and Dependencies

Assumptions

- The ticketing system contains reliable priority, category, and assignment data.
- Stakeholder email addresses and team-routing information are current.
- The organization has access to approved Microsoft automation tools.
- Users follow established ticket-submission procedures.

Dependencies

- Ticketing-system integration or accessible data source.
- Microsoft Power Automate licensing and permissions.
- Defined priority and escalation standards.
- Stakeholder approval of the proposed workflow.
- Access to reporting tools such as Power BI.

13. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Incorrect priority data triggers the wrong escalation	Validate business rules and test with sample cases
Duplicate notifications	Add status checks and unique escalation identifiers
Workflow failure	Configure failure logging and administrator alerts
Unauthorized access to ticket data	Apply role-based permissions
Low user adoption	Provide training and concise process guides
Reporting discrepancies	Perform data validation and quality-assurance testing

14. Recommended Next Steps

1. Confirm current-state process with business stakeholders.
2. Validate escalation categories, priorities, and routing rules.
3. Obtain stakeholder approval of the documented requirements.
4. Build a prototype automation using sample data.
5. Conduct user-acceptance testing.
6. Measure results against the proposed success targets.
7. Refine the workflow before production deployment.

15. Approval

Name	Role	Approval Date
	Business Owner	
	IT Operations	
	Technical Lead	